

The ADHD Healthy Habits Handbook FROM **ADDITUDE**

Follow this guide to:

- Learn how to create and stick to routines and habits
- Minimize overwhelm and maximize what matters most
- Regulate stress and big emotions
- Gain a better sense of self
- Improve and strengthen your relationships
- and much more!



ADDITUDE

A trusted source of advice and information for families touched by attention-deficit disorder—
and a voice of inspiration to help people with ADHD find success at home, at school, and on the job.

additudemag.com/shop

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Introduction

“ADHD affects the whole person — the mental, emotional, physical, spiritual, and social self. It increases daily stress and chips away at a positive sense of self. It interferes with self-care and makes it hard to keep healthy habits.” — Lidia Zylowska, M.D.

This self-guided *ADDitude* handbook is designed to help you prioritize your wellbeing, with help from leading experts in adult ADHD who offer their insights and advice in webinars, supplemental readings, expert Q&As, downloadable resources, and more.

From understanding your ADHD brain and motivations to developing healthy habits for physical and mental wellness, each section of this guide centers on improving an aspect of living that is undoubtedly touched by ADHD.

By working through this handbook, you will learn:

- How to gain a better sense of self to carve out the life you want
- How to create — and stick to — routines and habits
- How to apply time management and organization strategies to minimize overwhelm and maximize satisfaction
- How to manage stress and regulate intense emotions
- How to develop healthy habits around exercise, sleep, nutrition, and other fundamentals
- How to eradicate ADHD shame by practicing self-compassion
- How to improve and strengthen your connections with others
- And much more!

Table of Contents

Wellbeing Lesson #1: **Who Are You? Understanding You and Your ADHD**
How to develop self-awareness and understand how ADHD impacts every facet of life . . . 5

Wellbeing Lesson #2: **The Power of Routines and Habits**
How to create new habits and stick to routines to ensure daily progress..... 10

Wellbeing Lesson #3: **On Time Management and Getting Things Done**
How to guard your precious time and get the most out of each day 13

Wellbeing Lesson #4: **An Organized Life**
How to keep your spaces organized and simplified to reduce overwhelm 17

Wellbeing Lesson #5: **Health and Nutrition for ADHD Bodies and Brains**
How to leverage exercise, nutrition, and sleep for better health..... 21

Wellbeing Lesson #6: **Emotional Resilience and Stress Management**
How to manage big emotions and reduce stressors in your life..... 24

Wellbeing Lesson #7: **Decrease Shame, Increase Self-Esteem**
How to dismantle ADHD shame and increase your sense of self-worth. 28

Wellbeing Lesson #8: **Relationships and Connections Matter**
How to strengthen your existing relationships and forge new ones to protect wellbeing . . . 32

Wellbeing Lesson #1: Who Are You? Understanding You and Your ADHD

Self-awareness is a fundamental aspect of wellbeing. Without it, you lack important information about your areas of strength and need, and how your ADHD symptoms (and symptoms of other potentially co-occurring conditions) uniquely show up in your life. As you build self-awareness, you'll learn which aspects of your life require more attention so that you can honor your needs and thrive.

On-Demand Webinars from **ADDitude** Advisors

Please note that the following lectures are all free to watch, but our system requires an email address to unlock them. We will never sell or spam your email address.

1. [“What Is ADHD? Everything You Need to Know”](#) by William Dodson, M.D., LF-APA

William Dodson, M.D., LF-APA, is a board-certified adult psychiatrist who has specialized in ADHD for the last three decades. He was named a Life Fellow of the American Psychiatric Association in recognition of his clinical contributions to the field of ADHD. In this webinar, Dodson describes how ADHD manifests in adults — from high levels of creativity to mood lability — and the conditions that commonly occur with ADHD.

additu.de/mcweb1a

2. [“ADHD Is a Whole-Life, Whole-Body Experience”](#) by Linda Roggli, PCC

“You are unique not only with your ADHD but in every other way as well,” says Linda Roggli, PCC, an ADHD coach and the founder of the A-D-Diva Network. Here, she discusses how ADHD is much more than the sum of its parts, and the importance of accepting — not rejecting — your condition.

additu.de/whole-webinar

Wellbeing Lesson #1: Who Are You? Understanding You and Your ADHD

3. “[7 Insights Into the ADHD Brain That Transform Lives](#)” by Jeff Copper, PCAC, PCC, M.B.A.

If you're struggling to manage ADHD, it could be because you're looking at the roots of your challenges all wrong, says Jeff Copper, PCAC, PCC, M.B.A., an ADHD coach and the founder of DIG Coaching Practice. He shares truths about living with ADHD like the following that will ultimately help you carve out the life you want:

- The ADHD brain is emotional, reflexive, and likes to seek escape.
- Popular productivity tools may stifle the ADHD brain.
- Rehearsing the past won't change the future.

additu.de/hweb1c

4. “[How ADHD Shapes Your Perceptions, Emotions & Motivation](#)” by William Dodson, M.D., LF-APA

All individuals with ADHD share these defining features, according to Dodson:

- They have an interest-based nervous system. “If a person with ADHD can get engaged, they can do anything.”
- They experience rejection sensitive dysphoria — an intense vulnerability to being rejected or criticized by other people.
- They experience internal hyperarousal, which translates to, “I can't shut off my brain.”

additu.de/dodson-symptoms

5. “[You Mean I'm Not Lazy, Stupid, or Crazy?! New Empowering Lessons for Adults with ADHD](#)” by Peggy Ramundo, B.S., A.C.T., SCAC

Peggy Ramundo, B.S., A.C.T., SCAC, is an ADHD coach and co-author of *You Mean I'm Not Lazy, Stupid or Crazy?! — one of the best-selling self-help books for adults with ADHD*. Here, she shares her guide for living with ADHD, which includes insights like the following:

- A mistake should not be a black mark on your soul.
- You alone are enough. You have nothing to prove to anybody.

Wellbeing Lesson #1: Who Are You? Understanding You and Your ADHD

- The greatest challenge in the human experience is discovering who you really are. The second greatest is living in a way that honors what you discover.

additu.de/notlazy

Required Reading

1. [“Intention Deficit Disorder: Why ADHD Minds Struggle to Meet Goals with Action”](#) by Russell A. Barkley, Ph.D.

Russell A. Barkley, Ph.D., the influential ADHD researcher, practitioner, and educator, coined the term “intention deficit disorder” to describe a central struggle of ADHD: “People with ADHD know what to do, but they can’t do what they know,” Barkley says. Read on to learn more about this core component of ADHD and how to close the gap between intention and action.

additu.de/hweb1f

2. [“ADHD Self-Empowerment Begins with Finding Your ‘Right Difficult’”](#) by Edward Hallowell, M.D.

Edward Hallowell, M.D., a psychiatrist and the founder of the Hallowell ADHD Centers, says that all people with ADHD need to find their “right difficult” — an activity that is equal parts challenging and captivating — to thrive.

additu.de/hweb1g

3. [“How to Re-Build a Life: 7 Framing Tools for ADHD Minds”](#) by Michele Novotni, Ph.D.

Offering enduring advice presented in early 2020 amid COVID lockdowns, Michele Novotni, Ph.D. — a psychologist, coach, and former president of the Attention Deficit Disorder Association — shares tools and ideas like the following for looking inward to carve out the life you want:

- Clear the deck: Imagine removing elements of your life as a way to start from scratch and assess what’s really important.
- Use the “Wheel of Life” tool to see how happy you are in certain areas of your life, and where you can use improvement.

additu.de/hweb1h

Wellbeing Lesson #1: Who Are You? Understanding You and Your ADHD

4. [“Your Strengths Inventory: Repairing Self-Esteem After an ADHD Diagnosis”](#) by Robert Pal

Robert Pal, an ADHD coach, offers thought-provoking questions like the following to help you understand your areas of strength and need and determine next steps for your life, especially if you were diagnosed with ADHD as an adult:

- What activity gives you energy?
- What’s working in your life?
- What’s important to you?
- What are you proud of?

additu.de/inventory

5. [“Why ADHD Self-Awareness is the Key to Effective Action, Change, and Progress for Each of Us”](#) by Susan Lasky, M.A., BCC, SCAC

Susan Lasky, M.A., BCC, SCAC — an ADHD coach, professional organizer, and the co-founder of the ADD Resource Center — offers strategies to increase self-awareness and unlock real change and progress in your life:

- Take an honest strengths/challenges inventory.
- Let go of the victim mentality. Instead of focusing on what you can’t do, look toward what you can.
- Change happens when strategies are clear and realistic, objectives are specific, and goals are achievable.

additu.de/hweb1j

6. [“When It’s Not Just ADHD: Symptoms of Comorbid Conditions”](#) by Larry Silver, M.D.

In ADHD, co-occurring conditions are the rule, not the exception. The presence of other conditions can influence how ADHD symptoms appear, and can also affect treatment. Here, Larry Silver, M.D., a one-time clinical professor of psychiatry at Georgetown Medical Center in Washington, D.C., and director of training in child and adolescent psychiatry at Georgetown University School of Medicine, provides an overview of the conditions commonly associated with ADHD.

additu.de/hweb1k

Self-Test

[The ADDitude Symptom Checker](#)

additu.de/checker

Free Download

[9 Conditions Often Linked to ADHD](#)

additu.de/linked

eBook

[How the ADHD Brain Works](#) from ADDitude

additu.de/mcweb1v

Reader Essays and Tips

1. [“20 Rules to Live By: My ADHD Life Guide”](#) by E.V. Lansky

Highlights from this blog post:

- Study successful people with ADHD.
- Beware of time bandits.
- Stick to passionate endeavors.
- Be grateful, despite inevitable hardships.

additu.de/hweb1o

2. [“Why My ADHD Brain \(and Yours\) Loves to ‘Complexify’ Things”](#) by Linda Roggli, PCC

Roggli ponders the following question in this personal piece: “How do I balance my need to get things done with my need to make things interesting and complicated?”

additu.de/hweb1p

Wellbeing Lesson #2: The Power of Routines and Habits

Routines and habits ground us. They instill structure and healthy predictability (i.e., less stress) into our lives. Ultimately, our routines and habits shape us. But you can shape your habits and routines for a better life, too.

On-Demand Webinar from **ADDitude** Advisors

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[“The Healthy Habits Playbook: How to Make Meaningful Changes Actually Stick”](#) by Michelle Novotni, Ph.D.

From habit-stacking to chaining, these strategies are designed to solidify new and desirable behaviors while undoing counterproductive habits.

additu.de/hweb2a

Supplemental Video

[“Setting Up Routines for Adults with ADHD”](#) by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

Sharon Saline, Psy.D., is a clinical psychologist and ADHD expert with decades of experience working with children and families. In this real-time support group session via Facebook Live, Saline identifies five steps to creating and maintaining ADHD-friendly routines.

additu.de/hweb2b

Required Reading

1. [“7 Self-Defeating Behaviors That Aggravate ADHD — and How to Fix Them”](#) by Alan P. Brown

Intentionally or not, you probably engage in habits that make your life harder than it needs to be. Here, Alan P. Brown, an ADHD coach and the founder of ADD Crusher, lists

Wellbeing Lesson #2: The Power of Routines and Habits

the most common counterproductive tendencies he sees among adults with ADHD, and offers steps to address each behavior.

additu.de/self-defeat

2. [“How to Change Habits: 4 Ways to Make New Behaviors Stick”](#) by Christine Li, Ph.D.

Christine Li, Ph.D., a clinical psychologist and procrastination coach, says old habits are hard to break because they are tied up with beliefs about who we are. To truly change habits, you’ll need to set your vision and fight for what you want, among other steps described here.

additu.de/habit

3. [“Your Evening Routine Is Broken”](#) by Kathleen Nadeau, Ph.D.

Kathleen Nadeau, Ph.D., is a psychologist and the founder of the Chesapeake Center for ADHD, Learning, and Behavioral Health in Maryland. Here, she suggests ideas like the following for restful evenings and smoother mornings:

- Prepare breakfast and lunch the night prior for the following day.
- No screen time in the hour before bed.
- Take a warm shower the night before.
- Avoid entering “reactive mode” in the A.M.

additu.de/hweb2e

Free Download

[The Daily Routine That Works for Adults with ADHD](#) from *ADDitude*

additu.de/daily-routine

Expert Q&A

[“7 Daily Intentions for Brains In Search of Structure and Purpose”](#) by Leslie Josel

Leslie Josel is an student/ADHD and parenting coach and the founder of Order Out of Chaos. Here, she provides a simple roadmap for organizing your day — perfect for those who feel overwhelmed at the thought of creating a schedule.

additu.de/hweb2g

Reader Essays and Tips

1. [“What Is Your Most Reliable, Helpful Daily Routine?”](#) by *ADDitude* editors

A nightly calendar review. A daily walk, rain or shine. No social media in the A.M. These are the habits and routines among many others that help *ADDitude* readers lead satisfying lives.

additu.de/rituals

2. [“The Three Rs for Ruling Your ADHD”](#) by Kristen Caven

Routines, Rewards, and Rituals — the ADHD trifecta.

additu.de/hweb2i

Wellbeing Lesson #3: On Time Management and Getting Things Done

The ability to keep track of time and make the most of your day increases feelings of fulfillment and accomplishment. There are plenty of workarounds for the most common ADHD-related challenges with time and productivity: time perception, motivation, inattention (or even too much attention), and more.

On-Demand Webinars from **ADDitude** Advisors

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1. [“Why Is Time So Slippery? Understanding Time Blindness in People with ADHD”](#)
by Ari Tuckman, Psy.D., M.B.A., CST

ADHD minds are locked in the present and struggle to “see” and “feel” the future, says Ari Tuckman, Psy.D., M.B.A., CST, a psychologist who treats teens and adults with ADHD. Here, Tuckman explains how ADHD warps time perception, and offers techniques to solve common time management challenges.

additu.de/time-webinar

2. [“Hacking the Science of Your ADHD Brain: 5 Secrets to Productivity”](#) by Linda Walker, PCC

Understand how to work with, not against, your ADHD brain. Trick yourself into getting things done by creating novelty, describing your goals with detailed precision, and recognizing your energy levels.

additu.de/hweb3b

3. [“How to Get More Done with a Lot Less Stress!”](#) by Susan Lasky, M.A., BCC, SCAC

Clarity and priority are key to making things happen, Lasky says in this webinar chock-full of tips to minimize overwhelm and maximize productivity.

additu.de/hweb3c

Required Reading

1. [“ADHD Minds Are Trapped in Now \(& Other Time Management Truths\)”](#) by Ari Tuckman, Psy.D., M.B.A.

Learn strategies like the following to get around time blindness:

- Use tools that externalize time (planners, analog clocks, etc.)
- Imagine that you are doing your future-self a favor.

additu.de/hweb3d

2. [“10 ADHD Rules for Guarding Your Precious Time”](#) by Sandy Maynard, M.S.

Learn to say no. Set clear boundaries. Always double the time. And more tips from Sandy Maynard, M.S., a coach and the founder of Catalytic Coaching, for improving time management.

additu.de/precioustime

3. [“Stop Dodging That Dreaded Task! 9 Ways to Halt Avoidance Procrastination”](#) by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

“It’s not that the task is actually terrible; you just have an incredibly distorted perception of its difficulty or unpleasantness,” Saline says.

additu.de/5things

4. [“Don’t Be a Victim of Your To-Do List”](#) by Gretchin Rubin

Do you get lost or overwhelmed in traditional to-do lists? Try “could-do,” “ta-da,” and “to-day” lists instead, suggests Gretchen Rubin, an author, podcaster, and speaker.

additu.de/hweb3g

Wellbeing Lesson #3: On Time Management and Getting Things Done

5. [“What Stops Me from Starting?”](#) by June Silny

Procrastination has nothing to do with time management and everything to do with emotions. “You procrastinate because you’re unable to effectively regulate your own emotions — a trademark symptom of ADHD,” says June Silny, an ADHD coach. Here, you’ll learn about the following:

- The six types of procrastinators.
- Common causes of ADHD procrastination and solutions for each.

additu.de/starting

6. [“What’s My Motivation? \(No, Seriously, I Need to Get Started.\)”](#) by Laurie Dupar, PMHNP, RN, PCC

Laurie Dupar, PMHNP, RN, PCC, is a trained nurse practitioner, an ADHD coach, and the founder of the International ADHD Coach Training Center. Here, she provides six strategies for building motivation to get things done, and questions to ask yourself to understand your motivational challenges.

additu.de/hweb3i

7. [“Flow State vs. Hyperfocus: On Channeling Your Unsteady ADHD Attention”](#) by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

Hyperfocus is a step beyond being in a flow state, Saline says. Periods of intense focus can be great for productivity, but you need to plan breaks and come up with an exit strategy to avoid burnout from hyperfocusing.

additu.de/hweb3j

Free Downloads

1. [The Eisenhower Matrix for ADHD Decision-Making](#)

additu.de/ike

2. [Better Time Management with Adult ADHD](#)

additu.de/hweb3l

eBook

[Getting Things Done with Adult ADHD](#) from ADDitude

additu.de/gtd

Reader Essays and Tips

1. [“How to Get Started: 5 Ways I Overcame Chronic Procrastination”](#) by Mareen Dennis, M.S., LPP

Grab the easy part of the task. “Intend” for 10 minutes. Use these strategies and more for getting unstuck.

additu.de/pair-up

2. [“13 Productivity Playlists to Center and Focus ADHD Brains”](#) by ADDitude editors

Many adults with ADHD swear by the power of music to help them focus. From upbeat, high-energy songs and instrumental tracks to film soundtracks, give one (or all) of our reader-approved playlists a try to channel your attention.

additu.de/adhd-music

3. [“Use Your Time Wisely by ‘Spending’ It with Intent”](#) by Avery Walsh, M.A., ET/P

“We can think of time the same way we think of money,” suggests Avery Walsh, M.A., ET/P, an ADHD coach and educational therapist. “We are constantly advised to invest, to set an emergency fund, to track our expenses, and to spend our money with intention. So why not invest and bank our time more intentionally as well?”

additu.de/hweb3p

4. [“Everyday ADHD: Quirky Productivity Hacks for Easily Bored Brains”](#) by ADDitude editors

From creating artificial deadlines to storing items in unconventional places (like deodorant in the car), get inspired by these productivity hacks from ADDitude readers.

additu.de/hweb3q

Wellbeing Lesson #4: An Organized Life

An organized space is one that reduces overwhelm and makes your life easier. The best organization plan is the one you'll stick to. Remember that it doesn't have to be perfect — just good enough for you.

On-Demand Webinars from **ADDitude** Advisors

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1. [“Conquer Clutter, the ADD Way: 7 Practical Steps to Organizing a Messy House”](#) by Linda Roggli, PCC

Among the many takeaways from this webinar: Examine your buying habits, follow the 80/20 rule, downsize your life, and mold organization solutions to fit your life. Roggli also shares her favorite organizing products and tools — from clear storage bins to office organizers.

additu.de/hweb4a

2. [“Everything in Its Place: The ADHD Guide to Better Organization”](#) by Lisa Woodruff

Lisa Woodruff, the founder of Organize365, explains how executive dysfunction is at the root of disorganization, and shares four things to think about as you start to organize any space in your home: trash; food and dishes; clothing; and 15-minute organizing tasks.

additu.de/hweb4b

3. [“Organization Solutions for People with ADHD”](#) by Susan C. Pinsky

Make organization the easy choice! In this webinar, Susan C. Pinsky, a professional organizer, shares helpful tips to create an organizing system that is quick, simple, easy, and maintainable.

additu.de/hweb4c

Required Reading

1. [“Home Neat Home: An ADHD Organization Plan”](#) by Lisa Woodruff

Twenty-seven tips and insights — plus a breakdown of Woodruff’s “Sunday Basket” strategy – to stay organized. A quick preview:

- Organization is a skill, not a talent.
- You’re not alone in your organizational struggles.
- Schedule a time to put things away.
- Take before and after photos to absorb how much you’ve done.

additu.de/home

2. [“I’m Too Ashamed to Clean My House”](#) by Beth Main, BCC, NCC

Disorganization is a source of shame for many people with ADHD — and shame can keep you from seeking solutions, says Beth Main, BCC, NCC, an ADHD coach and a professional counselor. Here, she offers six strategies for dismantling shame driven by organizing challenges, and actionable steps to neaten up your space today.

additu.de/hweb4e

3. [“Don’t Organize It, Purge It: 10 Things to Throw Out Now”](#) by Lisa Woodruff

These ten items — from old and unused electronics to plastic bags — likely make up most of the clutter in your home, Woodruff says. Read her tips — and solutions from readers — for clearing clutter.

additu.de/purge

4. [“The Ultimate Room-by-Room Organization Guide”](#) by Susan C. Pinsky

A few simple rules for efficiently and consistently organizing virtually every part of your home.

additu.de/hweb4g

Free Downloads

1. [Organize Your Home By Working With Your ADHD Brain](#)

additu.de/adhdtidy

2. [73 ADHD-Friendly Ways to Organize Your Life Now](#)

additu.de/organize

3. [Your Free Guide for Controlling Clutter](#)

additu.de/clutter-guide

eBook

[Declutter Your Life \(and Home! and Office!\)](#) from ADDitude

additu.de/declutterbook

Reader Essays and Tips

1. [“Which ADHD Organizational Tools Actually Work?”](#) by ADDitude editors

ADHD organization needs and tools are not one-size-fits-all. Here, the tools our readers say helps them keep organized and clutter-free.

additu.de/hweb4l

2. [“I Absolutely Hate Everything About...? Your Most Detested and Avoided Household Chores”](#) by ADDitude editors

It feels good to let it out — and to know that you’re not alone. Here, the chores our readers love to hate — from flossing and doing laundry to taking out the trash and ironing clothes — and what they do to avoid the task.

additu.de/hweb4m

Wellbeing Lesson #4: An Organized Life

3. [“10 Hacks for Conquering Household Chores with ADHD”](#) by *ADDitude* editors

A companion of sorts to the above article, readers offer their tips and hacks for following through on dreaded chores in this piece.

additu.de/chores

4. [“Now That I’m Organized, I Realize I’m Happier in Chaos”](#) by Katy Rollins

What happens when there’s no clutter to declutter? No mess to pick up? Katy Rollins, an *ADDitude* blogger, grapples with adjusting to a life where “chaos isn’t conducting the orchestra.”

additu.de/hweb4o

Wellbeing Lesson #5: Health and Nutrition for ADHD Bodies and Brains

Our behaviors around nutrition, exercise, and sleep have a tremendous effect on our health — a fact that’s amplified for ADHD brains and bodies. Maximize each of these building blocks to help you control your symptoms and start every day on the right foot.

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1. [“Healthy Habits for ADHD Brains: Everyday Activities That Unlock a Longer, Healthier Life”](#) by Ari Tuckman, Psy.D., M.B.A., CST

An overview of the building blocks of a healthy lifestyle — restful sleep, nutritious eating, stress-busting exercise, and more — and questions to ask yourself to form good habits in these areas.

additu.de/hweb5a

2. [“The Whole-Person Treatment Approach to ADHD”](#) by Lidia Zylowska, M.D.

Lidia Zylowska, M.D., is an educator, researcher, and practitioner who specializes in treating adults with ADHD. Her practice integrates conventional treatments with holistic and complementary-alternative medicine to support well-being. She expands on her integrative, whole-person philosophy to ADHD management here, and touches on elements like the following:

- lifestyle factors that impact symptoms (stress management; relationships; sleep and exercise)
- supplements and herbs for ADHD
- the importance of mindfulness and self-compassion

additu.de/hweb5b

3. **[“Revenge Bedtime Procrastination: How Women with ADHD Can Break the Cycle of Delayed Sleep and Stress”](#)** by Christine Li, Ph.D., and Tracy Otsuka, J.D., LLM, AACC

Revenge bedtime procrastination — the practice of putting off sleep to pursue leisure activities — typically happens when you don’t get enough time during the day to engage in fulfilling, pleasurable activities. Sleep problems inherent in ADHD along with regulation challenges also play a role in delaying sleep. Here, Li joins Tracy Otsuka, J.D., LLM, AACC, an ADHD coach, to discuss this phenomenon and present strategies to create healthy sleep patterns.

additu.de/rbp

Required Reading

1. **[“Beyond Genes: Leveraging Sleep, Exercise, and Nutrition to Improve ADHD”](#)** by Joel Nigg, Ph.D.

Joel Nigg, Ph.D., a clinical psychologist and professor in the departments of psychiatry and behavioral sciences at Oregon Health & Science University, explains how changes to your eating, fitness, and sleep habits can have positive effects on ADHD symptoms. He provides action steps for each area.

additu.de/hweb5d

2. **[“The ADHD Exercise Solution”](#)** by John Ratey, M.D.

John Ratey, M.D., a psychiatrist and educator, explains what the research says about the ADHD-exercise link, and provides strategies — the same tips he gives his patients with ADHD — to get moving and manage your symptoms.

additu.de/11o

3. **[“How to Fall Asleep with a Rowdy, Racing ADHD Brain”](#)** by Roberto Olivardia, Ph.D.

Roberto Olivardia, Ph.D., is a clinical psychologist and clinical instructor of psychology at Harvard Medical School. Here, he provides an overview of the sleep problems and conditions associated with ADHD, and steps for falling and staying asleep — from keeping a sleep diary and taking melatonin to practicing proper sleep hygiene.

additu.de/rowdy

4. [“Build a Better Relationship with Food to Benefit Your ADHD Brain”](#) by Roberto Olivardia, Ph.D.

Learn about the foods and vitamins that do ADHD brains good — protein, complex carbs, omega-3 fatty acids, antioxidants, etc. — and how to practice mindful eating to support healthy functioning.

additu.de/food-brain

5. [“Healthy Eating Habits for Impulsive, Dopamine-Starved ADHD Brains”](#) by Roberto Olivardia, Ph.D.

Learn how to practice mindful eating and how to create a plan to stick to healthy eating and nutrition habits.

additu.de/hweb5h

Free Downloads

1. [How to Sleep Better with ADHD: A Guide for Adults](#)

additu.de/hweb5i

2. [5 Rules for an ADHD-Friendly Diet](#)

additu.de/foodrules

3. [Top 5 Vitamins and Supplements for ADHD](#)

additu.de/5supp

eBook

[The Diet & Nutrition Guide for Adults with ADHD](#) from ADDitude

additu.de/diet-guide

Reader Essay and Tips

[“This Simple Sleep Formula Calms My Racing ADHD Brain”](#) by Alex R. Hey, PCAC

In Bed + Feeling Tired + A Calm Mind = Sleep. That’s all it takes to catch some Zs, according to Alex R. Hey, PCAC, an ADHD coach.

additu.de/sleep-formula

Wellbeing Lesson #6: Emotional Resilience and Stress Management

Emotional dysregulation is part of the ADHD experience — and one that spills over into practically all parts of life. Emotional resilience and stress management are the antidote to explosive emotions, runaway thoughts, and intense feelings.

On-Demand Webinars from **ADDitude** Advisors

Please note that the following lectures are all free to watch, but our system requires an email address to unlock them. We will never sell or spam your email address.

1. [“When ADHD Triggers Emotional Outbursts: Scripts for Your Flashpoints”](#) by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

Yes, the ADHD brain is wired to overreact and feel emotions intensely. But you can learn how to control emotional reactivity with the right tools and frame of mind. Here, Saline recommends strategies to manage anger and frustration, and scripts for navigating tense situations.

additu.de/trigger-webinar

2. [“Build Your ADHD Emotional Resilience: Strategies for Adults Who Feel Things Deeply”](#) by Tamara Rosier, Ph.D.

Are you a “hurler” (someone who takes out emotions on others) or a “hider” (someone who shoves emotions inside)? Tamara Rosier, Ph.D., an ADHD coach and the founder of the ADHD Center of West Michigan, offers strategies to help hurlers and hidiers find emotional release while minimizing damage to themselves and to others.

additu.de/hweb6b

3. [“The ADHD-Anxiety Link: How Mindfulness Helps You Feel Less Overwhelmed and Be More Productive”](#) by Lidia Zylowska, M.D.

When ADHD difficulties provoke anxiety, worry, stress, and overwhelm, mindfulness can help you cope, Zylowska says. In this webinar, you’ll learn how ADHD and anxiety interact, and mindfulness exercises to help you relax.

additu.de/hweb6c

Required Reading

1. [“How ADHD Ignites Rejection Sensitive Dysphoria”](#) by William Dodson, M.D., LF-APA

A must-read resource for all people with ADHD, this article explains rejection sensitive dysphoria (RSD) as an extreme emotional sensitivity and pain triggered by the perception of rejection or criticism from others. Dodson writes that it’s a major part of ADHD that affects mood and emotional responses.

additu.de/rsd-adhd

2. [“How to Tap the Brakes on Runaway Emotions”](#) by Ari Tuckman, Psy.D., M.B.A., CST

Learn 15 strategies for improving emotional regulation that center on the basics: managing stress, recognizing and planning for triggers, and owning up to your reactions.

additu.de/hweb6e

3. [“Simplify Your Life: 7 Habits That Bring Calm and Stability”](#) by Linda Roggli, PCC

“The ADHD brain is pushed to its limits when life’s demands pile on with no end in sight,” Roggli writes. Her tips for streamlining your life to reduce stress include the following:

- Distract your amygdala with a six-second pause.
- Clear physical clutter, which often worsens mental clutter.
- Learn to say no.

additu.de/hweb6f

4. [“After the Shame: How to Re-Center Your Bruised Emotions”](#) by James Ochoa, LPC

When losing your cool becomes an all too familiar experience, it can lead to shame and additional emotional distress, says James Ochoa, LPC. Here, learn five ways to rebalance during or after experiencing a wave of big emotions.

additu.de/hweb6g

5. [“Overstimulated by Life? 20 Ways to Give Your ADHD Senses a Break”](#) by Zoë Kessler

“Overstimulation is a daily reality for many people with ADHD,” writes Zoë Kessler, an author and a motivational speaker. Read her top strategies for managing physical and emotional sensitivities.

additu.de/overstimulated

Expert Q&A

[Q: “I Can’t Handle Rejection. Will I Ever Change?”](#) by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

Five ways to cope with the very real emotional pain of RSD.

additu.de/recover

Free Downloads

1. [How Well Are You Handling Stress? Rate Your ADHD Coping Strategies](#)

additu.de/hweb6j

2. [9 Truths About ADHD and Intense Emotions](#)

additu.de/9-truths

eBook

[Mindfulness & Meditation for ADHD](#) from ADDitude

additu.de/mindful

Reader Essays and Tips

1. [“Have I Overreacted? Big Time? 5 Ways I Rectify Emotional Outbursts”](#) by Les Steed

How to bring yourself down from a stressful situation: Take a breather, remove yourself from the chaos of the movement, and return once you’re calm. Apologize if you need to.

additu.de/hweb6m

2. [“9 Calming Strategies for a Racing, Restless Mind”](#) by Kate Moryoussef

Kate Moryoussef is a wellbeing and lifestyle coach for women with ADHD. Here, she describes the techniques that quiet her inner chatter and help her break out of patterns of overthinking.

additu.de/hweb6n

3. [“Slow Down and Live Stress-Free”](#) by Jennifer Koretsky

Jennifer Koretsky, an ADHD coach, writes about how overwhelmed she felt by everyday life before her diagnosis in adulthood, and how slowing down helped her create a healthier lifestyle.

additu.de/hweb6o

Wellbeing Lesson#7: Decrease Shame and Increase Self-Esteem

Shame and poor self-esteem related to ADHD show up in many ways (from perfectionism to feelings of regret and more) and chip away at wellbeing. Learn how to overcome ADHD stigma to reduce shame and develop a healthy sense of self.

On-Demand Webinars from **ADDitude** Advisors

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1. **[“The Adult Guide to Shedding ADHD Shame”](#)** by Linda Roggli, PCC

“Learning to leave shame behind is a rebirth for many ADHD adults, one that is long overdue and well deserved for most of us,” Roggli says. Here, learn about how shame develops in adults with ADHD, and how to take the first steps toward forgiving yourself.

additu.de/hweb7a

2. **[“Perfectionism and ADHD: Making ‘Good Enough’ Work for You”](#)** by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

Shame and feelings of inadequacy trigger perfectionism — an unhealthy insistence on personal flawlessness — in many adults with ADHD, Saline says. Learn about this under-recognized aspect of ADHD in this webinar and how to stop setting unreasonable standards for yourself.

additu.de/385

Wellbeing Lesson #7: Decrease Shame and Increase Self-Esteem

3. **[“From Shame and Stigma to Pride and Truth: It’s Time to Celebrate ADHD Differences”](#)** by Edward Hallowell, M.D., and William Dodson, M.D., LF-APA

The antidote to shame is pride. In this webinar, you’ll learn how to cultivate pride and celebrate being differently wired.

additu.de/stigmaweb

4. **[“The ADHD Guide to Fighting Stigma: How to Defend Your Diagnosis and Build Your Self-Esteem”](#)** by Rick Green, M.C., OOnt, B.Sc.

Rick Green, M.C., OOnt, B.Sc., is a comedian and the founder of Totally ADD. Here, he shares how he uses positivity and humor to enlighten ADHD doubters, increase acceptance, and eliminate shame.

additu.de/hweb7d

Required Reading

1. **[“Life Is Too Short for Shame”](#)** by Edward Hallowell, M.D.

Learn how to view ADHD from a neurological perspective, not a moral framework, to reduce shame.

additu.de/noshame

2. **[“‘Perfect Is a Myth’ — and Other Self-Esteem Boosters”](#)** by Ari Tuckman, Psy.D., M.B.A., CST

Five ways to build your confidence each and every day — all while accepting your imperfections.

additu.de/hweb7f

3. **[“Squirrel Bingo: The Game That Makes You Feel Good, Positive, and Confident”](#)** by Nicole Perkowitz

A bingo-style game created by Nicole Perkowitz, a coach, to help you notice all your moment-to-moment accomplishments, whether it’s leaving to work on time, eating a nutritious meal, or using positive self-talk.

additu.de/squirrel

Wellbeing Lesson #7: Decrease Shame and Increase Self-Esteem

4. **[“The ADHD-Friendly Guide to Asserting Yourself”](#)** by Sandy Maynard, M.S.

A handy script when you need to stand up for yourself, according to Maynard: “I feel ____ when you ____, and ____ would be a great solution.”

additu.de/hweb7h

5. **[“Silence Your Harshest Critic — Yourself”](#)** by Tamara Rosier, Ph.D.

If you use shame to motivate yourself (as many people with ADHD do) use Rosier’s tips to soften your inner critic and learn how to live more peacefully with yourself.

additu.de/criticism

6. **[“You Are Worthy of Self-Compassion: How to Break the Habit of Internalized Criticism”](#)** by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

Learn how to practice self-compassion in four steps — from recognizing that you are not alone to giving shame a name.

additu.de/1cy

7. **[“Your Regret Won’t Change the Past. These Tips May Save Your Future”](#)** by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

“For some people, living with ADHD can feel like 1,000 tiny paper cuts — an emotional slice felt each time we missed things, made mistakes, and received unfair or unkind treatment,” Saline writes. Here, learn the four Rs for defeating emotional pain and shame.

additu.de/dysregulated

Expert Q&A

Q: **[“What Does ‘Be Yourself’ Mean for Adults with Fractured Self-Esteem?”](#)** by Leslie Josel

“So, when I say ‘Be yourself,’ it means to embrace all of you — identifying and celebrating your strengths, while also acknowledging your weaknesses,” Josel writes.

additu.de/hweb7l

Reader Essay

[“Has ADHD Warped Your Sense of Self? It’s Time to Reclaim Your Story — and Power”](#)

by Alise Conner, Ph.D.

“ADHD is a web of deeply rooted memories and stories...they are hard to shake and may warp our self esteem,” writes Alise Conner, Ph.D., a clinical psychologist and ADHD specialist. Here, learn how to reframe your past and practice self-compassion.

additu.de/reclaim-you

Wellbeing Lesson #8: Relationships and Connections Matter

Strong ties with family, friends, and other loved ones keep us going. Strengthen your existing connections and grow your circle (if your heart desires) to improve your happiness and protect your wellbeing.

On-Demand Webinars from **ADDitude** Advisors

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1. [“The Secret to Making Friends: A People Skills Guide for Adults with ADHD”](#) by Caroline Maguire, M.Ed., ACCG, PCC

Making and keeping new friends is hard enough, and adults with ADHD face additional challenges with symptoms like impulsivity and inattention, which can get in the way of meaningful connection. Here, Caroline Maguire, M.Ed., ACCG, PCC, a personal coach who specializes in social emotional learning, and the author of *Why Will No One Play with Me?*, explains ADHD-related social skills challenges, and strategies for reading social cues and becoming a better listener, among other skills.

additu.de/hweb8a

2. [“Start with ‘Hello:’ How to Reduce Social Anxiety and Foster Connections”](#) by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

Are you holding back from participating in the relationships that you truly desire? In this webinar, you’ll learn how to participate in social situations with more confidence and less discomfort and self-criticism.

additu.de/hweb8b

3. **[“Gaslighting, Love Bombing & Beyond: How to Recognize \(and End\) Toxic Relationships with ADHD”](#)** by Stephanie Sarkis, Ph.D.

Stephanie Sarkis, Ph.D., is a psychotherapist and author. Here, she discusses why people with ADHD may be more susceptible to unhealthy relationships, and how to identify toxic traits in romantic partners, family members, friends, and others in your life.

additu.de/toxic

4. **[“My Partner Has ADHD?!’ 5 Strategies for Living Happily After a Diagnosis”](#)** by Melissa Orlov

Melissa Orlov is a marriage consultant who specializes in ADHD and relationships. In this webinar, she discusses all the ways ADHD can show up and impact a relationship, and the strategies that have a positive effect on a partnership.

additu.de/hweb8d

Required Reading

1. **[“Are You Ducking and Dodging the Connections You Need Most?”](#)** by Edward Hallowell, M.D.

“All of us sink without enough human connection, no matter how unsinkable you may think you are,” Hallowell writes. Here, his 13 tips to forge connections with family, friends, significant others, and other loved ones that will enrich your life.

additu.de/hweb8e

2. **[“Married with ADHD: How Real Couples Make It Work”](#)** by Linda Roggli, PCC

More than 700 adults with ADHD opened up about their married life and how they stick with their spouses through thick and thin. Learn about the “marital medicine” that ensures a strong ADHD relationship.

additu.de/bliss

3. [“We Need to Talk About How ADHD Affects Interpersonal Relationships”](#) by Elizabeth Broadbent

Elizabeth Broadbent, a writer and longtime contributor to *ADDitude*, describes how ADHD symptoms ranging from impulsivity and emotional dysregulation to forgetfulness affect all kinds of interpersonal relationships — an aspect of living with ADHD that doctors and researchers seldom talk about.

additu.de/hweb8g

4. [“The ADHD Guide to Naturally Flowing, ‘Normal’ Conversations”](#) by Sharon Saline, Psy.D.

Learn how to join, participate, and leave a conversation. Saline’s APPLE acronym is a handy tool to help you remember the basics of conversation — from maintaining appropriate physical proximity to laying off the self-criticism.

additu.de/conversation

5. [“How to Find Love \(and Like!\) When You Have ADHD”](#) by Edward Hallowell, M.D.

Most people with ADHD are “incurable romantics” who pay a big price for being wired that way, according to Hallowell. Here, he explains why like is sturdier than love, and questions to ask yourself to know if you are “deeply in like” with a person before you commit to them.

additu.de/hweb8i

6. [“11 Rules for Fighting Right and Forgiving Faster”](#) by Melissa Orlov

Orlov explains how couples can have a “good fight” and the importance of recovering after an argument.

additu.de/hweb8j

Free Download

[Manage ADHD’s Impact on Your Relationship](#)

additu.de/sabotage

eBook

[*The ADHD Guide to Making Social Connections*](#) from *ADDitude*

additu.de/ebook-bff

Reader Essays and Tips

1. [“We Each Trust That the Other Is Doing Their Best”](#) by *ADDitude* editors

Tips from our readers on how to make it work when one or both partners in a relationship have ADHD.

additu.de/hweb8m

2. [“He Said, She Said, They Danced”](#) by Rebecca Brown Wright

“For any marriage to work, particularly one that includes ADHD, you’ve got to replace the comparisons and tallying with conversations and listening,” writes Rebecca Brown Wright, a blogger and longtime contributor to *ADDitude*.

additu.de/hweb8n